

Pioneer Junior College

GP Bulletin 2018

Issue 2



The world is your textbook

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Section A: The student essays in this section are graded C - B.

The objectives of the essays in this section are to illustrate how mistakes in various components of essay writing can result in a lower grade.

The mistakes of each essay are explained in the margins, and learning points summed up at the end of each essay.

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Section B: The student essays in this section are graded A.

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Minor mistakes of each essay (if any) are explained in the margins, and learning points summed up at the end of each essay.

Page 18 How far should countries encourage open trade with other countries today?

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Page 27 In today's world, has ethics taken a backseat where food is concerned?

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This section serves to highlight good evaluative techniques in the AQ, and how they can be sufficiently addressed.

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Section A

Vidhya Bharathi 17S06 ‘Tradition does more harm than good.’ To what extent do you agree with this statement? Traditions refer to actions and practices which are handed down from generation to generation. There are many traditions and cultures which stem from around the world. Most cultures and traditions include the aspect of sacrifice, which is sometimes considered dangerous to participants of the traditions. Do practicing these traditions result in more negative than positive impacts? I strongly feel that most traditions do more good, such as bringing people together and allowing good values to be passed down, than harm, which results in violation of human rights of individuals. Traditions bring people of various ages together. Many practices include one’s family participation to make the event more enjoyable. It provides an opportunity for young and old alike to interact and bond over the same activities. One such example is the fasting of Muslims during the Muslim month of Ramadan when one is not allowed to eat or drink from dusk till dawn. As such, breaking fast at the same time gives an opportunity for all members of the family to come together and dine, which is sadly not common in today’s society where everyone is busy and choose the eat at their own preferred times. This meaningful activity of fasting gives all of them a similar experience to talk about as well. Another example will be Thanksgiving which often includes a dinner feast with loved ones, regardless of family or friends. After showing their appreciation and gratitude, they dine in joy and happiness. Similarly, this provides them with an opportunity to bond. As such, upholding traditions provides a platform for interaction and joy with loved ones. Hence, there is always value in upholding such traditions which deepens one’s relationships and there is no harm in doing so. Traditions also allow parents to hand down good values from themselves to their children. Practicing of certain traditions with children allows the young malleable minds to learn new concepts and values which are upheld by their loved ones and maybe even their society. For example, Pongal Festival is an event celebrated annually in India every January. Traditionally, farmers and their families cook with the freshly harvested rice and offer them to the gods and the Sun for a fruitful harvest. During this event, animals such as cows which help in farming are decorated with garlands and praised throughout the festive season. This may teach the young gratitude and the importance of co-existence, with their environment and other living beings, when large communities share the joy of the event. The Chinese tradition of a newlywed couple offering tea to their elders in exchange of blessings teaches them the value of respect and humility, which are essential to a life with healthy relationships. Without practising these traditions, the value of these ethics may be lost with time, leaving them as empty, meaningless acts. These values may have the most impact when learnt since young, with one’s own parents as role models. Thus, there is no harm in raising better children and a new generation by using traditions to hand down good and irreplaceable values. However, not all traditions are good and some are harmful for participants, as it violates their human rights. Some traditions can result in negative physical, emotional and psychological impacts for people. One such tradition is a coming-of-age ceremony for boys in a Brazilian tribe where both their hands would be trapped in gloves filled with bullet ants while forcing the boys to endure	Comparative There is no need to restate the question in the introduction, it would be more effective to state the perspectives and arguments directly. Relevant point, but it's unclear what 'family participation' mean. ✓Feature of modern world included ✓Relevant examples to support point made. Lacks comparison within the BP ✓Good PEEL BP Lacks comparison within the BP Clear transition. However, there is no comparison made between the harm and good. For a more convincing evaluation, there is a need to weigh the harm and benefit
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the pain for a period of time without crying. Another example is the tradition of genital mutilation of females, which violate the rights of girls and women. Since ancient times, China has had a tradition of binding the feet of young girls, resulting in 'lotus feet' as a symbol of status. The smaller her feet, the higher her social status. This left many women unable to move around or walk without help, this redistricting her freedom. These are some of the many traditions worldwide which result in harm for the participants. Some of them may be crippled for life or tormented by trauma. In these cases, regardless of the values taught by the practice, they should be considered harmful as the rights of a human to have a free will and choose among their choices themselves take priority. Therefore, such traditions which are a few of the many do more harm than good. Traditions such as a patriarchal values and practices also do more harm than good when it limits the opportunities of others. Male dominance over female in society was present in many cultures in the past and is still present in today's modern society. As a result, the path travelled by men and women to the same destination can be very different. Two of such examples are Kalpana Chawla, the first female Indian astronaut, and Malala Yousafzai, who was even shot in her head for advocating for female's rights to education. Many women like them have struggled much more than men to see the same results due to the patriarchy, which puts women down and ties them to traditional duties of bearing children and being a housewife, instead of giving them the freedom they deserve. Even in today's modern society, in conservative countries, such as Saudi Arabia, women are not allowed to leave their homes without a man's company and until recently, were not allowed to drive. Therefore, traditions which limit humans of opportunities to freedom in excelling in their ambitions and instead cripples them to a future not chosen by them should not be advocated for as they do more harm than good. However, many of such harmful traditions are being banned by various governments and organisations, leaving mostly only good traditions to be practiced. One such example is the binding of the feet of Chinese woman, which was banned by the Chinese government due to its detrimental effects to their health. As mentioned before, the ban on Saudi Arabian women which restricts them from driving was recently lifted, showing a glimmer of hope for the freedom of Saudi women. Extremely harmful and traumatising traditions such as human sacrifice have been long banned and cut out of practice, further showing that if there were any harmful traditions, they would have been out of practice by now. Furthermore, in today's globalised world, many do not have the means to practise traditions the way they used to be in the past. Certain practices of today may even be considered a 'diluted version' making it only a shadow or a fragment of how significant it was in the past. During this process, many harmful traditions have been excluded from practice. Hence, traditions today rarely pose any great harm to humans and are mostly good and safe to be conducted. Overall, most traditions do more good than harm as they result in more positive impacts than negative ones. Traditions provide a platform for bonding and bequeathing good values while making pleasant memories. However, traditions which violates human rights and limits opportunities of humans should not be in practice as they have more negative impacts than positive ones. As Henry James said: "It takes endless amount of history to make even a little tradition" and many of such practices which requires so much effort could not possibly be harmful, thus making most traditions wholesome. GRADE: C (High)	within the BP. ✓ Good range of examples provided. The link states that it does 'more' harm than good, but there was no comparison and evaluation being made. The examples provided here appear to overlap with the previous BP on human rights. In other words, the previous BP is constitutive, or a subset of this paragraph. This can be avoided with better planning and organisation of points. Lacks comparison within the BP Repeated examples which shows that the student could have better organised the ideas to ensure better development of ideas. Some attempt at comparison within the BP Overall, student did not successfully compare both positive and negative impact at either the essay or BP level to show how one may be more than the other, which is a key question requirement A clearer explanation of Henry James' quote is needed.
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Learning Points:



Relevant arguments and specific examples provided for both harms and benefits of traditions.



Comparison of harms and benefits not consistently done in the essay. Student merely listed down both perspectives separately before superficially coming to the conclusion that there are more benefits. Evaluation needs to be evident to address the 'More...than...' trigger. Points should have been better organised to avoid overlapping or repetition. Each point should be clearly distinct from another.

Tan Jamie 17S12

'The arts are only for entertainment.' Discuss.

The arts are a very diverse entity in our culture, regardless of time. It takes on many forms. The conventional shape of the arts ranges from visual arts such as paintings, lithography to traditional music and poems, while modern arts may be presented as performing arts like contemporary dance, drama, films and the list goes on. It exists in every aspect of our lives and has such prominent stance in the society because of its functions. Some critics may say that the arts are only for entertainment, but is that true? If it is only for entertainment's sake, would it survive the test of time from way back to prehistoric period till now? No. The arts have many other uses in different sectors such as education, our social life and even in politics. While it is true that the arts can be used to derive pleasure, it is definitely not the only use.

One of the greatest and most influential artist of all time, Jacques Louis-David was a French painter who had exceptional skills in creating oil-based paintings. He lived through the French Revolution and played a significant part in driving the process of revolution using his own means – the arts. He painted many works requested by clients with similar mindsets regarding the revolution. Many of his paintings are based on political situations in his time and were pro-revolution. It has done a great deal in influencing people's choice of governance and way of life. As seen from this example, the arts can be used as tools in politics to sway people's ideals. It is a dangerous weapon when used in politics as we can see, the role of Jacques's paintings in the gruesome French Revolution. Although some may argue that it is for the greater good, regardless of its effects, it is undeniable that when used in politics, the purpose of the arts is not entertainment to a large extent. This is because such artworks usually hold meaning. As in this famous quote, "a picture speaks a thousand words", it explains that the arts could be a more humane way in getting access to our hearts. It can speak to many people regardless of language, race and religion. Thus, making it a deadly double-edged sword in the realm of politics. On a less violent scale, the arts can also be used to commemorate past political actions. It can bring us back to the past, this is especially so for realist arts such as The Treaty of Waitangi. It seeks to show the equality and fairness practiced when the treaty was signed by the locals and British authorities in New Zealand. This helps people create a better understanding for the situation in the past and thus, the present, which can be very helpful in maintaining political stability.

The arts are one of the platforms which people can connect to others. Humans are social creatures, we seek connections with one and the other. These interactions help maintain our emotional and psychological stability, as presented by the Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs. During National Day celebrations in Singapore, many national songs that would arouse nationalistic fervor are played and sung by Singaporeans. Songs such as "Home" by Kit Chan is widely sung across the little red dot as many people can understand the meaning of the song through similar experience and emotions. This allows all Singaporeans feel greater belonging, thus unites the nation. As seen, this form of art can be used to find similarities with other people, thus, helps us understand and communicate with each other. Even without any interaction with other people, just the motion of singing the song has a great impact on an individual's feeling that they belong and are connected to others. On a more personal level, acts such as reading storybooks and listening to our favorite song can help us connect to its creator. This is because we come to know little details about the creator's beliefs, style and behaviors when we interact with their

Absolute-cum-multifactor comparison

✓ Clear awareness and understanding of keywords shown.

Student should not restate the question. Instead, a clearer line of argument would have been more effective.

✓ Absolute trigger word in the question addressed.

Point should be clearly stated before any example is given. This prevents going off tangent, and helps your reader follow a clear train of thought.

✓ Attempts made to link back to the absolute trigger word 'only'.

✓ Clear point raised to highlight another function of the arts.

A broader range of examples should be provided.

Given that this is an absolute-cum-multifactor comparison question, there is a lack of clear comparison with the given factor in the question 'entertainment' in the entire BP.

works. Of course, with this we can find people who are like minded more easily because we can appreciate similar arts. This is made possible on a greater extent due to advancement in technology. For instance, fans of Harry Potter all over the world can now connect to one another using websites like Pottermore. Those who enjoy K-pop also have their own social platforms. This brings many people on a common ground to socialise. Therefore, the different forms of arts can also be used as catalyst for social activities. Furthermore, the arts can also be used for educational purposes. While some may argue that the arts may be one-sided as it presents issues through a single person's lens, it stills hold great value as it shows us a side of the argument, allowing people to have a more holistic view of things. On the internet, Randall Munroe, an artist, started posting many different comics in his website a few years ago. The comics show his view of things in the world. One of his art pieces called "Connected" effectively shows his criticism against the view of love adopted by many young people, educating people that it is actually infatuation. Offline, many different non-governmental organisations (NGOs) who are calling for support for a cause are also using the arts to educate people. They use many interesting ideas that revolve around the arts to create an impact on people. To create awareness about the farming of bears in Australia, an NGO printed posters with bears and made parts of the poster sticky. The posters were pasted on the ground at public places such as the train stations. As people walk on top of the poster, the dirt on their shoe soles remain on the sticky parts of the poster. The sticky parts of the posters were arranged in a shape of a cage. Therefore, after many people have stepped on the poster, the cage appeared to trap the bears. The result of the campaign was quite astounding. Many people who saw the poster were dumbfounded at first but after scanning the QR code at the side of the poster, found out that the message of the poster was that it was because of their "ignorance" that the bears were being caged. Campaigns like these use arts to make people understand their wrongdoings without offending. This is because people start enlightening themselves and find meaning attached to the arts quickly, making the message of the campaign memorable and reasonable for them to follow and take actions for. The arts are a form of expression. Creators create art so as to convey something. It also means that it is made for an audience. Without an audience the function of the arts could be poisoned. However, many arts only appeal to their audience when it gives them pleasure. Therefore, the arts, to a certain extent is also created and used for entertainment. Many people read storybooks, watch dramas, recite poems and practice other forms of literature in their free time. This is because they may feel more relaxed when indulging in another person's world presented in their works. The arts can be a form of escape from reality. It can make us forget about things happening around us by captivating us in their beauty. We may practice them as a stress reliever or a hobby. However, in both instances, it is done for the fun of it. For example, some people may be interested in watching comedians so that they have their fair share of laughing for the day. This could be because they want to feel happy in the moment. The arts in this case can help people find balance in their lives by entertaining them. The arts exist in many forms and for each of these forms, they play a different role in politics, education and social parts of our lives. It is doing arts injustice to claim that it is only used for entertainment. The arts are a lot more powerful than that. While it does bring a fair share of laughter and happiness by entertaining us, it can play other roles too. Arts can be used in politics to influence and persuade, tools used in our social life to connect with people and tools used to learn more effectively. However, it is vital for us to understand that the use of the arts overlaps with one and the other, even within a sector of concern. For	✓ Good range of illustration provided to highlight yet another function of the arts. Too many unnecessary details provided about this one campaign by an Australian NGO. Again, the comparison with the given factor 'entertainment' is missing. Student could have made use of the examples as an opportunity to show how people found the experience fun yet educational at the same time. ✓ This body paragraph, unlike the previous two, does show comparison with the keyword 'entertainment'. Examples in this paragraph lack scope and cogency. Clear transition needed to signal that this is the conclusion.
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instance, within politics, people may draw comics to illustrate their views, such as mocking a certain action by the government. While some of us get its message, we may also find it hilarious and therefore, it may also serve as an entertainment. The arts have its grey areas when it comes to its functions, but for sure, it does not just entertain people. Furthermore, the extent for which arts entertain people is very subjective. It depends on the personality of the creator and viewer, how far we are willing to analyse a piece of art and ultimately, our taste and preference for the things we find entertaining. GRADE: C (High)	It is not necessary to repeat all earlier arguments or to provided additional new examples in the conclusion. Conclusions should seek to be concise and summative in nature.
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Learning Points:

-  Clear awareness of the various functions of the arts.
-  Consistent use of concrete evidence needed in the body paragraphs. There needs to also be consistent comparison and reference made to the given factor 'entertainment', given the comparative element in the question 'only'.

Are fictional superheroes of any importance?

STEP 1: Analyse the Question Requirements (QTK)

Q => Yes or No. Greater evaluation shown by arguing the extent of importance.

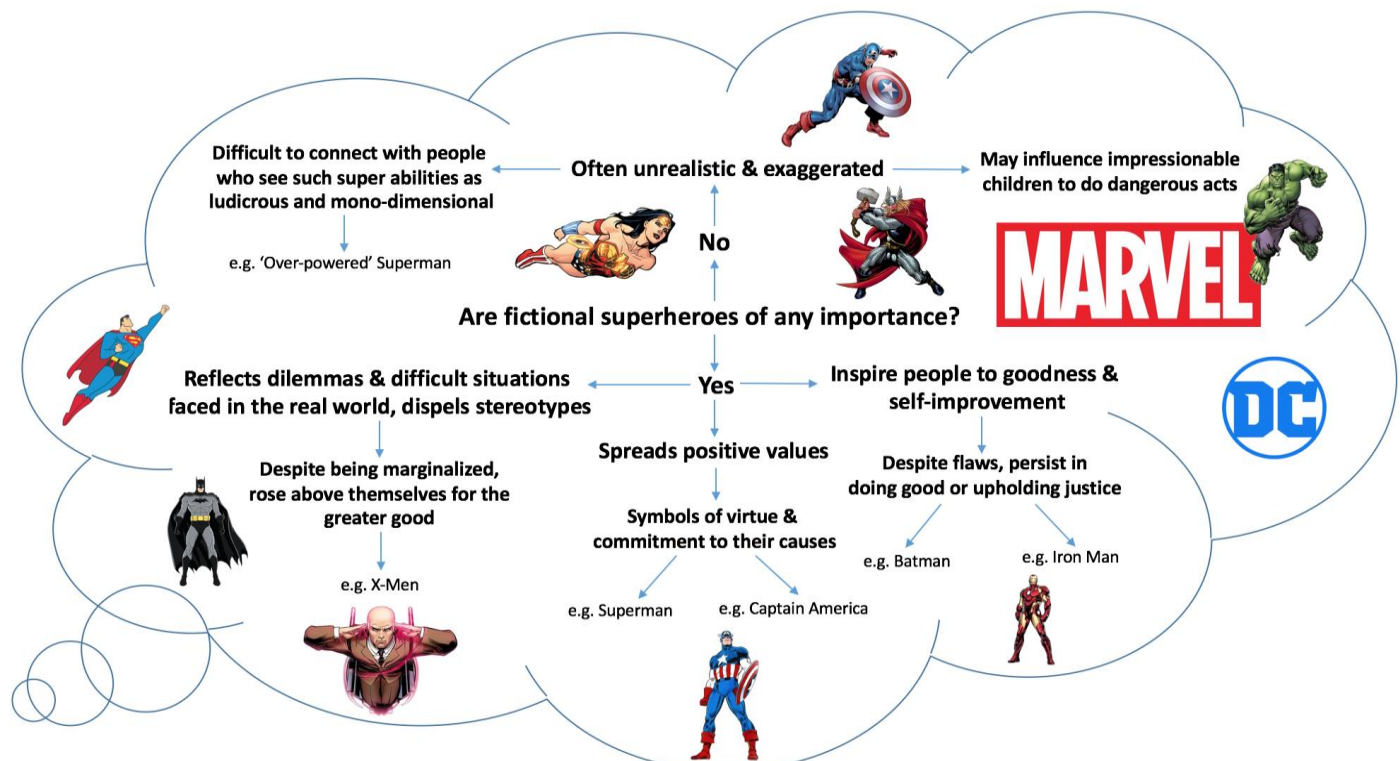
T => Whether fictional superheroes play a significant role in society, given that they are not real

K => Fictional superheroes = typically imaginary individuals of extraordinary powers who appear as the main characters of books and movies, saving the weak and ensuring justice against their arch-nemesis e.g. supervillains

Any = an absolute term with an assumption that challenges the often unrealistic and exaggerated abilities of fictional superheroes

Importance = to be evaluated in tandem with the absolute term 'any' in terms of e.g. real-life significance, practical benefits, long-term, short-term, magnitude of impact etc.

STEP 2: Brainstorm for Relevant Content (5 brainstorming techniques)



STEP 3: Decide on Thesis

THESIS: I, however, feel that fictional superheroes are of great importance.

STEP 4: Organise Content

Qualified Thesis: Yes

<u>Intro + Thesis (GIST)</u> G: Justice! Capes! Fighting against evil! A questionable fashion sense! These are just some of the things that come to mind when one thinks of fictional superheroes. I: To put it in the simplest of terms, superheroes are those who serve and protect the innocent and the weak from the forces of evil, as well as perform generous acts of heroism of their own volition. <u>More often than not</u>, these 'heroes' are also equipped with powers and abilities that allow them to do what no normal human can, <u>hence</u> the word 'super'. S: <u>And of course</u>, they <u>only</u> exist in works of fiction. Some may think that fictional superheroes exist only for entertainment purposes, having minimal impact on people's lives. T: I, however, feel that fictional superheroes are of great importance.	<u>Thesis</u> G: <i>The nature of the topic leaves room aplenty for an imaginative opening, which the writer capitalizes fully to elicit the interest of the reader.</i> I: <i>Note the felicitous use of language, vocabulary and discourse markers to nuance the 'I', instead of settling for 'dictionary-like' definitions</i> S/T: <i>Note the use of discourse markers to smoothen the transition between the 'I' and the 'S'</i> * Contrary to assumption, following a GIST structure in an essay introduction does not necessarily curtail creativity, as this writer has shown
<u>Supporting BP1: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Perhaps the most well-known effect of the existence of fictional superheroes is that they educate us on the <u>importance</u> of positive values. L (concluding sentence): However, when incorporated into entertaining, action-packed narratives, it is much easier for these lessons to get through to people, hence the great importance of fictional superheroes to us.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is YES)</u> <i>Notice how the keyword 'importance' is addressed in the T.S., and how this is variedly done to answer the question (ATQ) and yet avoid sounding repetitive</i>
<u>Supporting BP2: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): ... another reason for why fictional superheroes are <u>important</u> is they inspire people to do good and improve themselves. L (concluding sentence): They inspire us to strive to do the impossible, to push ourselves to the limit and to be the best that we can be. After all, if they can, why can't we?	
<u>Supporting BP3: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): I feel that some of the most <u>important</u> parts of superheroes are the dilemmas they face... they go through many difficult situations that are reflected in the real world. L (concluding sentence): This could open the eyes of those who were so thoroughly misguided and blinded by their racism before, and help the problem be more widely understood. Allowing us to achieve progress forward not as people of individual races, but as one race, the human race.	
<u>Supporting BP4: Reason for No + Evidence</u> P (Antithesis): Despite the numerous arguments mentioned earlier that extol the importance of superheroes, there would be critical stalwarts who refuse to see them as any more than mere figments of imagination, citing that they are too often, over-exaggerated characters conjured to spur the lust for entertainment, but nothing more. L (concluding sentence): Thus, for all the wonders of superheroes, they are ultimately meant to drive sales and profits, for a booming industry catering to viewers in perpetual need of escapism from the mundanity of real life.	**Note that this <u>suggested anti-thesis paragraph</u> should ideally be included in the essay for <u>balance</u>, instead of merely being cursorily introduced in the introduction and re-visited in the conclusion as a brief thought
<u>Conclusion: Considering these situations, I maintain largely Yes.</u> Such is the importance of fictional superheroes. Some may feel that they are simply for the use of entertainment. And while it is true that they do have entertainment value, it is clear that they are so much more than that. Fictional superheroes inspire us, they teach us, and they show us the issues we have been avoiding our whole lives. Most importantly, they give us hope for the future: they create real superheroes.	<u>Reiterate Thesis</u> ***As with the above comment, the antithesis argument about superheroes having no more than just entertainment value and hence serving little importance, <u>should be developed into a full body paragraph in the essay</u>

Are fictional superheroes of any importance?

Justice! Capes! Fighting against evil! A questionable fashion sense! These are just some of the things that come to mind when one thinks of fictional superheroes. But what are they really? To put it in the simplest of terms, superheroes are those who serve and protect the innocent and the weak from the forces of evil, as well as perform generous acts of heroism of their own volition. More often than not, these 'heroes' are also equipped with powers and abilities that allow them to do what no normal human can, hence the word 'super'. And of course, they only exist in works of fiction. Some may think that fictional superheroes exist only for entertainment purposes, having minimal impact on people's lives. I, however, feel that fictional superheroes are of great importance. They teach, inspire and empower us and are a positive part of society today.

Perhaps the most well-known effect of the existence of fictional superheroes is that they educate us on the importance of positive values. An important prerequisite of being a superhero is that they must portray symbols of virtue, virtues that they must uphold no matter the situation. A good example of this is that of DC Comics' Superman. Superman is probably the pinnacle of virtue of the fictional world. He shows respect to all despite being more powerful than the average person. He upholds responsibility by always coming to the aid of whoever is in need. The importance of this is that when people, children and adults all read about such superheroes or watch them form television screens, they observe the effects and benefits of having positive values. Adults, who can discern how such values shape and improve society and themselves, and children, who take these superheroes as their role models and would want to be just like them, take on positive values portrayed by these larger than life figures. Usually, when values and the importance of having them are taught to students in their schools, the main messages fail to reach them, due to their disinterest in the subject. However, when incorporated into entertaining, action-packed narratives, it is much easier for these lessons to get through to people, hence the great importance of fictional superheroes to us.

On the subject of fictional superheroes being role models, another reason for why fictional superheroes are important is they inspire people to do good and improve themselves. All kinds of superheroes exist and all kinds of superheroes have the ability to inspire us. Mighty and invincible superheroes inspire people to not only improve their physical fitness, but also use their strength to do the right thing. Technologically-equipped superheroes inspire people to be more creative and inventive, teaching them how generating innovative ideas can benefit others greatly. Last but not least, the superheroes who have no real 'superpowers', the superheroes who are often the underdogs, lacking any superpowers, are not to be underestimated. The only tools these superheroes have to fight crime are their fists, which when compared to laser vision or super strength, is nothing impressive, but these superheroes are nothing short of impressive. DC Comics' Batman is one such example. Batman is nothing more than a man who dresses like a bat. Unlike his peers, Batman cannot fly, does not have super strength or a magical artefact that grants him powers. However, with only a body that he trained and built on his own, his intellect and some tools he invented, Batman has saved the world countless times, going head to head with enemies that overpower even Superman. This illustrates how important 'powerless' heroes like Batman are to us. Having no special abilities make these heroes that much more special and powerful to us. They are the ones we can relate to the most; they are ordinary people just like us, and yet they accomplish acts worthy of the

Absolute

Student should clarify why some see superheroes as entertainment. And entertainment should not be assumed to be unimportant.

More examples could be provided to foreground values and virtues embodied by superheroes.

✓ Student shows awareness of different groups of viewers.

Rather than explain how effective superheroes are, student should focus on answering the question: **What is important** about superheroes?

✓ Effective evaluation showing the relevance of the example to the point argued.

title “super”. They make us think, ‘if they can do it, why can’t I?’ They inspire us to strive to do the impossible, to push ourselves to the limit and to be the best that we can be. After all, if they can, why can’t we? Lastly, fictional superheroes are not just important because they give us someone to look up to, someone to set an example for us. I feel that some of the most important parts of superheroes are the dilemmas they face. Despite having all the powers they have superheroes are not always invincible. They have their own weaknesses and vulnerabilities. They go through many difficult situations that are reflected in the real world. For example, Marvel Comics’ X-Men are a team of superheroes who gain their powers via a mutant ‘X’ gene in their DNA. As the source of their powers are genetic, they are often looked upon with disgust by the human community in their fictional universe. Although they selflessly saved humankind on so many occasions when they could have easily excluded themselves from the conflict, they face harsh judgement and persecution from those they sacrifice their lives for. This is a reflection of the ugly yet real issue of racism existent in our society today. People in the real world are treated differently simply because they are the minority and of a different race, and just like the X-Men, their contribution to society are often unrecognised or simply ignored. This is a serious problem that unfortunately, is not well understood by everyone today. That is where fictional superheroes like the X-Men come in. When we read about or watch their adventures and their struggles, we observe them from an outsider’s perspective and we cannot be biased because we are not directly involved in their conflict. Yet, we can feel the impact and the pain they feel from the persecution they face due to their differences. This could open the eyes of those who were so thoroughly misguided and blinded by their racism before, and help the problem be more widely understood. Allowing us to achieve progress forward not as people of individual races, but as one race, the human race. Such is the importance of fictional superheroes. Some may feel that they are simply for the use of entertainment. And while it is true that they do have entertainment value, it is clear that they are so much more than that. Fictional superheroes inspire us, they teach us, and they show us the issues we have been avoiding our whole lives. Most importantly, they give us hope for the future: they create real superheroes. Grade: B	✓Insightful parallel made ✓Points of argument are clearly stated at the start and end of the essay. Effort should be made to avoiding sounding too repetitive i.e. paraphrase or show how the BPs have develop one’s understanding of the points.
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Learning Points:



Consistently relevant, effectively substantiated and cohesive. Good use of language and vocabulary.



Limited number of points raised. Opposing point slightly presumptuous and not developed in a BP and/or within each BP. Explanations not always focused (i.e. BP 1). Since this is an ‘absolute’ question type, balance should have been done within the BP to score better. Clustering several similar examples within the BP would enhance the essay given the numerous examples that can be used, rather than focusing on only one.

Is entertainment always a waste of time?

STEP 1: Analyse the Question Requirements (QTK)

Q => Yes or No. Greater evaluation shown by arguing the extent of importance.

T => Entertainment, as the term suggests, is assumed to be non-productive in nature and hence, a waste of time – or is it not?

K => Entertainment = an avenue of pleasures and pastimes, one key aspect of modern human civilization, and with rapid technological advancement in the 21st century, developed to be a multi-billion industry that increasingly defines the lifestyles of most of the world's population

Always = an absolute term that reveals the underlying assumption that entertainment is frivolous in nature and cannot be taken seriously

Waste of time = non-productive and should not be a priority or taken seriously, the inference being that productive work or pursuits come first

STEP 2: Brainstorm for Relevant Content (5 brainstorming techniques)

Social/P**sychological**

- Crass entertainment that only serves to test the limits of one's nerves, such as horror movies or slapstick comedy flicks may arguably be more of a waste of time as they do not serve to cultivate anything more than a temporary escape from reality
- Research has shown that watching television is a passive activity that is not only physically unhealthy, but also mentally detrimental, as it does not engage the brain actively, which in the long-run, may lay waste to one's mental acuity and psychological well-being (i.e. early onset of dementia)
- It is important to note however that, 'waste of time' is subjective – any form of entertainment could be considered entertaining to the individual engaged in it, and who may or may not find the activity a 'waste of time', e.g. bungee jumping could be hugely entertaining and worthwhile to some people who seek entertainment through extreme situations, while it could be a complete waste of time or even dangerous for someone who prefer 'safer' forms of entertainment
- Entertainment can help to support social causes via celebrities, e.g. ALS Ice-Bucket Challenge, Singapore's annual President's Star Charity, etc.

Education

- Entertainment with educational value is hardly a waste of time as it serves to both entertain as well as educate. Entertainment helps facilitate the transference of learning without the viewer having the need to consciously imbibe the lessons learnt. Examples range from variety shows that educate viewers on current societal trends in light-hearted ways, to more sophisticated documentary series.
- However, entertainment could also impart undesirable or negative values to not just impressionable youth, but even adults, e.g. some films with rampant violence have allegedly led to copycat crimes

Economic/**S**ocial

- Entertainment generates astronomical amounts of revenue and jobs globally, and just how staggering this industry is goes to testify that entertainment is not only not a waste of time, but in fact, a meaningful way in which people of the 21st century pass their leisure time and arguably what gives meaning to their lives.

STEP 3: Decide on Thesis

THESIS: However, entertainment is not always a waste of time because of the process behind the making of entertainment, when it is used for education, as well as a means of peaceful protest.

STEP 4: Organise Content

Qualified Thesis: Yes

Intro + Thesis (GIST)

G: It does not take long for the human mind to be filled with sensory stimuli.

I: Fuelled by our hunger for quick, dopamine-rewarding sources, entertainment has always been a part of the human experience ever since the dawn of mankind with song and dance to fill our leisure times. In the last 100 years, entertainment has evolved from traditional forms of entertainment to digital entertainment that is accessible now with just a touch of a button

S: pushing the entertainment industry to churn out as many media platforms as possible to capitalise on the growing market. With that comes the negative view that entertainment is a big waste of time as our lives are filled with empty and unnecessary entertainment with little to no intrinsic value, such as soap operas and dramas. In addition, entertainment that propagates bad values only worsens its reputation.

T: However, entertainment is not always a waste of time because of the process behind the making of entertainment, when it is used for education, as well as a means of peaceful protest.

Thesis

G: *While it sounds seemingly abrupt, notice how it has been used effectively to evoke relevant interest, while shedding off any notion of banal predictability*

I: *It is inescapable that one shows awareness and mentions entertainment in the contemporary context, no other age than the last hundred years had seen the most accelerated development of entertainment through technological advancement*

S: *The contrary side is introduced and briefly explained*

T: *The overall thesis is stated as the other side of the argument, to avoid repetition. However, the writer could actually put forth a more wrought qualifying reason (compared with the antithesis), by virtue of it being the chosen thesis*

Supporting BP1: Reason for Yes and No + Evidence

P (T.S.): Entertainment can be a waste of time when the form of entertainment has no intrinsic educational purpose.

L (concluding sentence): Thus, entertainment created for the purpose of entertainment can be a waste of time.

P (rebuttal): However, entertainment can also be a fantastic utilization of time when there are avenues for lessons to be taught.

L (concluding sentence): As such, entertainment is not always a waste of time as there are evidently lessons to be learned depending on the nature of the entertainment and the value it offers.

Your Arguments

(State when it is YES and NO)

Supporting BP2: Reason for Yes + Evidence

P (T.S.): Entertainment can also be a waste of time when it propagates undesirable values

L (concluding sentence): Thus, as these forms of entertainment could potentially negatively impact the healthy development of children, they are a waste of time as they do no good for society, especially when they propagate bad values.

Your Arguments

(State when it is YES)

Supporting BP3: Reason for No + Evidence

P (T.S.): At the same time however, entertainment can also be used for good in the form of peaceful protests.

L (concluding sentence): Thus, entertainment is not always a waste of time as it can be used to protest the unjust treatments of those who are vulnerable such as animals and minority populations.

Your Arguments

(State when it is NO)

Supporting BP4: Reason for No + Evidence

P (T.S.): In addition, entertainment is not always a waste of time as the meaning behind some of the entertainment we consume can inspire creativity and innovation.

L (concluding sentence): Entertainment is thus not always a waste of time when it promotes progression in arts and innovation, as well as to inspire the next generation of people to be the best versions of themselves.

Conclusion: Considering these situations, I maintain largely No

In a nutshell, entertainment is not all homogenous and it is really just an umbrella term for the many things we enjoy every day. However, people define good entertainment, it is important for us not to generalise all entertainment as a waste of time, and we should learn to discriminate the good from the bad as there are true gems to be found and appreciated in what may seem like a bucket full of worthless stones. Alas, it is in the eye of the beholder to find meaning or purpose in what we consume on a daily basis, and it is our very own responsibility to refine our tastes to appreciate the value of entertainment, and to educate ourselves against what is morally unacceptable by our own standards.

Reiterate Thesis

*** The writer includes an important insight that the value of entertainment is subjective, and does so subtly. Hence it is not whether entertainment is a waste of time per se, but which modes of entertainment could be a waste of time for the individual concerned (i.e. subjective) Thus, honing one's appreciation for one's choice of entertainment is key to making the most of one's time.**

Is entertainment always a waste of time?

It does not take long for the human mind to be filled with sensory stimuli. Fuelled by our hunger for quick, dopamine-rewarding sources, entertainment has always been a part of the human experience ever since the dawn of mankind with song and dance to fill our leisure times. In the last 100 years, entertainment has evolved from traditional forms of entertainment to digital entertainment that is accessible now with just a touch of a button, pushing the entertainment industry to churn out as many media platforms as possible to capitalise on the growing market. With that comes the negative view that entertainment is a big waste of time as our lives are filled with empty and unnecessary entertainment with little to no intrinsic value, such as soap operas and dramas. In addition, entertainment that propagates bad values only worsens its reputation. However, entertainment is not always a waste of time because of the process behind the making of entertainment, when it is used for education, as well as a means of peaceful protest.

Entertainment can be a waste of time when the form of entertainment has no intrinsic educational purpose. Mindless content, created with the sole intent for consumers to kill time, saturates the market. Prime examples of these forms of entertainment are horror movies such as Insidious, which follows the life of a family haunted by a spirit that lurks in their house, or Chucky which is a horror series famous in pop culture for its ridiculous and cheap jump scares. Certainly, while these movies might provide a temporary getaway from the real world, these movies do not teach good values or have any educational potential in any way as their only purpose is to entertain people by scaring the wits out of their skin. Similarly, video games like Candy Crush and Flappy Bird were created for people to fill small pockets of time such as waiting in transit or when waiting to be served. Certainly, the time spent on consuming such entertainment can be used more efficiently to catch up on the news or to exercise, where real tangible benefits can be felt. Thus, entertainment created for the purpose of entertainment can be a waste of time. However, entertainment can also be a fantastic utilization of time when there are avenues for lessons to be taught. Take Brave Wilderness for example, a channel on the video-sharing site YouTube that devotes its content to educating viewers on the dangers of wild animals. The channel's front man, Coyote Peterson is a trained zoologist and an animal expert, and has a video series where he challenges himself to climb the "pain index" by exposing himself to insect stings and animal bites. These videos include information on such creatures, precautions to take when we encounter them, as well as stomach-turning clips of him cringing in pain from intentionally getting bitten or stung. To most people, these videos are of certain comedic value as the thought of a man voluntarily getting hurt by dangerous animals is very intriguing and funny. Be that as it may, viewers would take away with them vital knowledge on respecting wildlife and a clear message to stay away from potentially dangerous animals. Aside from that, video games like the Assassin's Creed series also relate historical icons such as Benjamin Franklin and Abraham Lincoln, and can serve to educate players on history by delivering useful knowledge of history in a fun, entertaining and engaging way. As such, entertainment is not always a waste of time as there are evidently lessons to be learned depending on the nature of the entertainment and the value it offers.

Entertainment can also be a waste of time when it propagates undesirable values. It does not take long for an individual or even a child to walk along the

Absolute

✓ Acknowledges the opposing perspective while defining what constitutes 'a waste of time'

✓ Thesis addresses the 'trigger' clearly and provides a clear preview of the points to be discussed.

✓ Balance at the BP level addresses the absolute 'trigger' by showing how entertainment can simultaneously be both a waste and effective use of time.

aisle of video game sections of malls to be drawn in by the colourful displays of video game boxes. Unfortunately, many video games do not set correct societal expectations for children and may breed undesirable results. For example, the multi-award winning game, Grand Theft Auto is a gaming classic that rewards the player for committing crimes such as murder, drug trafficking as well as prostitution. As such, it is difficult to justify playing such games as a source of entertainment when it could potentially negatively influence impressionable young children, which make up a significant proportion of the player base, to normalize and trivialize such crimes, not to mention the addictive potential of such games that can easily trap avid gamers in a downward spiral of unhealthy gaming habits. On top of that, YouTube video-bloggers such as Logan Paul, who is one of the most popular internet personalities of this generation, are infamous for not being very good role models as evident from the recent scandals such as Logan Paul's Japan scandal where he bullied Japanese shop owners, dangerously stopping and disrupting traffic, as well as broadcasting him and his group of friends laughing at a man who had hung himself in the Japanese "Suicide Forest" to millions of his viewers, a large majority of whom are very young children. Thus, as these forms of entertainment could potentially negatively impact the healthy development of children, they are a waste of time as they do no good for society, especially when they propagate bad values.	
At the same time however, entertainment can also be used for good in the form of peaceful protests. The film 'Blackfish' is a documentary highlighting the struggles and abuse of Orcas, better known as killer whales, in captivity. Another similar film, 'Free Willy' that was released long before 'Blackfish', also came into international spotlight as it exposed the atrocities of captivity of the animal. The message was so strong that in 2016, the SeaWorld group of marine shows and zoos vowed to cease shows that exploited orcas and promised not to take in anymore orcas into captivity following an aggressive wave of investigations fuelled by heated backlash and public discourse after the release of both films, thus potentially saving many lives of marine animals for many years to come, as well as setting a new industry standard for the appropriate treatment of animals in captivity. On top of that, the movie "Straight Outta Compton" has a political narrative behind the discrimination of black minorities in the United States. Thus, entertainment is not always a waste of time as it can be used to protest the unjust treatments of those who are vulnerable such as animals and minority populations.	Lacks explanation of point before examples are given. Relevance of this example to the point needs to be clearly made
In addition, entertainment is not always a waste of time as the meaning behind some of the entertainment we consume can inspire creativity and innovation. Often overlooked is the creative process behind some of the many popular classics as well as what we normally see online and on television. Movies and video games for example, require the collective efforts of designers, artists, engineers, actors, researchers and industry specialists over many years of tedious work and devotion to their craft. The movie "Avatar" for example, which is a blockbuster hit that still remains one of the highest grossing films of all time, took a rigorous four-year long movie-making process to create such a masterpiece of a film that still inspires and wows all generations of people. Sports such as football and basketball, although might just be entertainment when seen at face value on our television screens, have value in inspiring spectators to work hard to achieve what they want in life. Nevertheless, there is indisputable value in such forms of entertainment. Entertainment is thus not always a waste of time when it promotes progression in arts and innovation, as well as to inspire the next generation of people to be the best versions of themselves.	✓ Provides examples from different industries that serve to entertain. Sport example should be developed to show <u>how</u> sport inspires.

In a nutshell, entertainment is not all homogenous and it is really just an umbrella term for the many things we enjoy every day. However, people define good entertainment, it is important for us not to generalise all entertainment as a waste of time, and we should learn to discriminate the good from the bad as there are true gems to be found and appreciated in what may seem like a bucket full of worthless stones. Alas, it is in the eye of the beholder to find meaning or purpose in what we consume on a daily basis, and it is our very own responsibility to refine our tastes to appreciate the value of entertainment, and to educate ourselves against what is morally unacceptable by our own standards. Grade: B (High)	Overview of points discussed should be brought out in the concluding paragraph ✓Good personal insight.
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Learning Points:



Consistently relevant with effective use of examples. Overall, well-organised with cohesion of arguments.

Good use of language and vocabulary.



Balance at BP level (like in BP1) should have been consistently done for subsequent BPs to secure an A.

Explanation of points and relevance of examples not always well/fully developed.

Section B

How far should countries encourage open trade with other countries today?

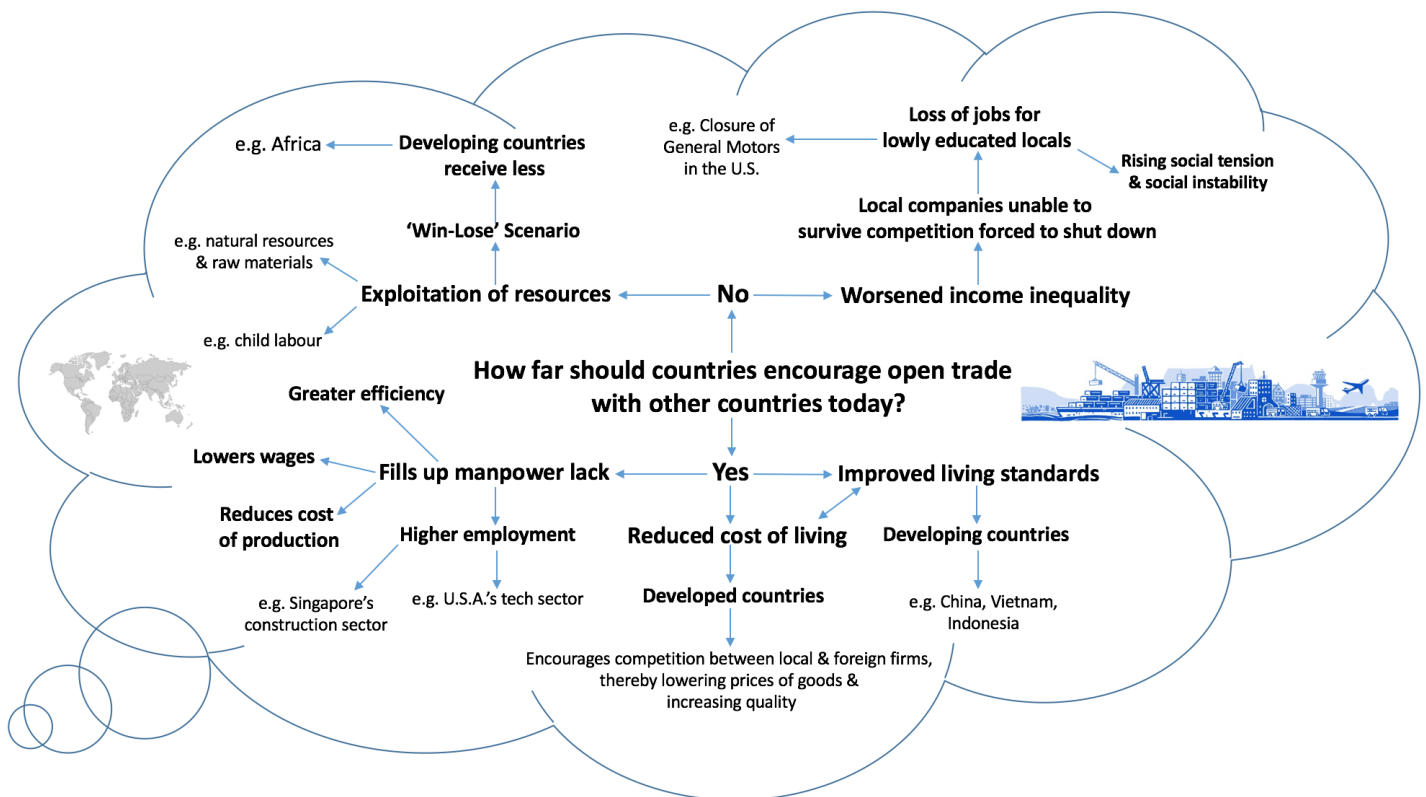
STEP 1: Analyse the Question Requirements (QTK)

- Q =>** How far = to a large or small extent. Greater evaluation shown by arguing the extent of importance.
- T =>** From the question, it is a given that open trade is very much to stay, but the issue lies with how much of it should be encouraged, given its range of benefits and disadvantages
- K =>** Should = the focus, 'should', is premised to a certain extent on 'could' (i.e. whether a country is placed at a necessity and/or advantage to engage in trade with other countries, and to what degree of) Countries encourage = focus is on the *perspective of a sovereign country*, namely one that operates from self-interest and perhaps, win-win situations of bilateral or multi-lateral trade relations

Open trade (between countries) = trade with minimal or no restrictions, leveraging the idea of comparative advantage where countries specialize in the production of certain goods and services while trading them with that of others

Today = context of globalization, where some countries are becoming increasingly protectionist due to technology and the complexity of manufacturing processes, putting them at a perceived disadvantage in global trade

STEP 2: Brainstorm for Relevant Content (5 brainstorming techniques)



STEP 3: Decide on Thesis

THESIS: I believe that countries should encourage open trade with other countries today to a larger extent.

STEP 4: Organise Content

Qualified Thesis: Largely Yes

<u>Intro + Thesis (GIST)</u> G: With the recent rise in globalisation, trade between countries is common and frequent. I: Trade, to some countries is a major economic industry, for a country such as Singapore. Singapore has numerous trade agreements, such as the Trans Pacific Partnership (TPP). However, trade to other countries, may not be a major economic role player. Based on the World Trade Organisation (WTO) standards, trade should only constitute 3% of a country's Gross Domestic Product. S: For countries such as the USA, trade is seen especially under the eyes of president Trump, as a reason for unemployment in the country. For others, such as China and Germany, trade is crucial to their economic growth. T: <u>With such mixed responses across the world</u>, I believe that countries should encourage open trade with other countries today to a larger extent. Its benefits, such as improving people's living, filling the lack of manpower, outweighs the cost of open trade.	<u>Thesis</u> G: <i>A somewhat staid opening that could be more riveting</i> I: <i>This part of the introduction seems more like an 'S', and while this is insightful information, more could be said about what the concept of open trade entails</i> S: <i>Example-driven, but hits home with relevant examples of countries and what trade means to them today</i> T: <i>Couching the situation as somewhat an impasse, the writer shows a balanced evaluation in his overall stand as a result of sustained analysis, reinforced by the qualifying reason of benefits outweighing the costs</i>
<u>Supporting BP1: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Firstly, open trade improves the living standard of the people L (concluding sentence): ...the people of both developing and developed countries get to enjoy high living standards. Thus, countries should encourage open trade.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is YES)</u>
<u>Supporting BP2: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Secondly, open trade allows countries to fill the lack of manpower in countries. L (concluding sentence): Open trade allows countries to fill their lack of manpower, it can help bring about economic growth. Thus, countries should encourage open trade with other countries today.	
<u>Supporting BP4: Reason for No + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): However, with open trade, comes many side effects to both the economy and society. They may bring about rising income inequality... L (concluding sentence): Thus, countries should regulate the companies moving overseas, to ensure that open trade does not worsen income inequality, while still encouraging open trade with other countries.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is NO)</u>
<u>Supporting BP5: Reason for No + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Secondly, open trade may result in exploitation of resources. L (concluding sentence): Thus, countries should regulate the ethics of goods manufacturing locally and overseas to ensure that governments can encourage open trade while still ensuring that human rights are upheld and resources are not exploited.	
<u>Conclusion: Considering these situations, I maintain largely Yes.</u> In conclusion, countries should encourage open trade with other countries today, as it brings about numerous benefits to people, companies and governments. However, the trade-offs of open trade being a multiplier of the problems of resources exploitation, the concentration of wealth and increasing income inequality, should not be neglected. <u>Countries should regulate local companies, ensuring that they stay and provide jobs for the locals. Governments should also regulate the business practices and export of crucial resources and to advocate for business ethics and human rights, in an effort to reduce the severity of resource exploitation.</u> If such measures were taken, countries should encourage open trade with other countries. Thus, I believe that countries should encourage open trade with other countries to a larger extent.	<i>*The conclusion is a part of the essay where insights not directly central or relevant to the essay question and BP arguments could be raised to add value and evaluation to the analysis.</i> <i>The writer acknowledges that there are clearly 'winners' and 'losers' with open trade, and while asserting that there are 'winners', this is not achieved automatically and depends on several factors, notably the involvement of government regulation and various stakeholders.</i>

How far should countries encourage open trade with other countries today?

With the recent rise in globalisation, trade between countries is common and frequent. Trade, to some countries is a major economic industry, for a country such as Singapore. Singapore has numerous trade agreements, such as the Trans Pacific Partnership (TPP). However, trade to other countries, may not be a major economic role player. Based on the World Trade Organisation (WTO) standards, trade should only constitute 3% of a country's Gross Domestic Product. For countries such as the USA, trade is seen especially under the eyes of president Trump, as a reason for unemployment in the country. For others, such as China and Germany, trade is crucial to their economic growth. With such mixed responses across the world, I believe that countries should encourage open trade with other countries today to a larger extent. Its benefits, such as improving people's living, filling the lack of manpower, outweighs the cost of open trade.

Firstly, open trade improves the living standard of the people. Trade brings jobs, prosperity, to developing countries, such as China. China, upon opening up to world trade, is deemed the manufacturing hub of the world. This has helped to catapult China from a third world country before 1978 to the country with the second highest GDP, at 12 trillion dollars. Rising developing countries, such as Indonesia and Vietnam, through trade, portray themselves as a manufacturer of garments and exporter of raw materials. Developed countries are not neglected from the benefit of open trade either. Open trade has reduced cost of living substantially. Cheaper forms of production overseas bring local good prices down. For example, auto companies such as Ford plan to shift production to China, in an attempt to reduce cost. Open trade has also allowed foreign companies to set up businesses in developed countries. These companies compete with local companies and disrupting the monopoly local companies once had, thus bringing down prices of goods. Thus, through the fact open trade benefits the developing countries by creating jobs, allowing them to sell raw materials to the global market and developed countries experiencing a decrease in prices of goods, the people of both developing and developed countries get to enjoy high living standards. Thus, countries should encourage open trade.

Secondly, open trade allows countries to fill the lack of manpower in countries. The trade of manpower is common worldwide. This action rectifies the lack of manpower in niche markets, such as the tech industry, or low quality jobs, such as construction. Singapore hires large numbers of foreign workers from China and India to work in the construction sector. The USA's tech market hires Indians, due to the lack of locals educated in the tech sector. The trade of manpower is crucial as without the qualified labour or the adequate labour workers, companies would be unable to continue to do business. A manpower shortage may cause companies to go bust, which would then affect the local economy. Therefore, trade of manpower is necessary to fill these empty positions, until sufficient locals are willing and educated to take up the jobs. Trade of manpower helps to reduce cost of production as well. Foreign labour competes with the local workforce, which brings down wages and improves efficiency. With lower wages, more companies can continue to operate. The companies may set up new branches, which can bring more jobs to the locals, thus benefiting the economy. Open trade allows countries to fill their lack of

Simple Polarity

The student has adopted a somewhat 'example-driven' approach in the introduction by highlighting the features of different countries. It would be better if these points could be phrased as arguments/ perspectives instead.

✓ Student has demonstrated understanding of the question requirements and keywords.

✓ Student has depth of understanding when it comes to how China has benefitted from trade.

✓ Relevant details highlighted when using China as an example. The student went further to provide a range of other countries who have also benefitted in a similar manner.

✓ Relevant point raised demonstrating awareness of real-world issues.

✓ Student has clearly brought in some relevant economic knowledge and has taken care not to sound too technical. Economic jargons are not used to confuse the reader.

manpower, it can help bring about economic growth. Thus, countries should encourage open trade with other countries today.

However, with open trade, comes many side effects to both the economy and society. They may bring about rising income inequality and the exploitation of resources. It is popular in media that open trade brings about a rise in income inequality. President Trump stated that due to trade agreements such as the North Atlantic Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA) and the TPP, Americans are losing manufacturing jobs to China and Mexico. With multinational companies moving production overseas, due to the higher local corporate tax rates, locals, especially uneducated ones, lose their jobs and find it hard to find substitute jobs. The recent closing down of a General Motors manufacturing plant left thousands unemployed. Large companies, on the other hand, get to shift production overseas and benefit from lower tax rates, lower wages and lower regulation on environmental degradation. This makes developing countries more attractive than developed countries and with many large firms shifting overseas, uneducated locals lose out, from the lack of jobs. An expanding income inequality affects a country's social stability. It can lead to riots, rising social tension, meaning that income inequality is unhealthy for a country. This can be seen from local workers in China protesting due to a sudden hike in bus fares. They protest due to the poor standard of living they receive and rising income inequality. Governments need to spend more on welfare such as subsidies and food stamps, which can be a financial burden on big countries such as the USA. The USA currently has 14 million people on food stamps. With the lower incomes earned by the poor and middle class, consumer spending would decrease. This would endanger provision shops, brick and mortar shops and with lower retail sales, the economy is affected. Thus, countries should regulate the companies moving overseas, to ensure that open trade does not worsen income inequality, while still encouraging open trade with other countries.

Secondly, open trade may result in exploitation of resources. Africa, a rising continent, has caught the eye of many, such as China. This continent, rich in oil, diamond and gold is an area that China has sought to dominate. This can be beneficial to Africa, as these countries see increased Foreign Direct Investments, which can help improve the continent's infrastructure. Due to open trade, China is able to export Africa's oil and raw materials back to their homeland. Africans receive less in return. Top executives in companies are Chinese and Africans still do not see a rise in locals taking top positions. In other countries such as war-torn Syria, child labour is common. Children are made to work in manufacturing plants for long hours, and are paid meagre salaries. What is made worse is that some American companies do purchase goods from these companies, indirectly involving themselves in child labour. The case where the soles of Nike shoes were made by child labourers was a popular incident that drew the attention of many. This exploitation of raw materials and child labour, is a problem in the world and open trade encourages such abuses to continue. This is unethical for companies and governments. Governments do try to stop the exploitation of child labour, but with open trade, the product can come from any company. Technologies have been created to detect the presence of child labour in the manufacture of products, but this is only the tip of the iceberg. Governments have to do more to prevent exploitation of their own resources or other countries' resources. Thus, countries should regulate the ethics of goods manufacturing locally and overseas to ensure that governments can encourage open trade while still ensuring that human rights are upheld and resources are not exploited.

✓ Clear transition and point made to highlight the extent.
✓ Relevant explanation to further expand on the point given in the topic sentence.

✓ Good range of examples provided to highlight how serious the problem really is. The length of this paragraph is rather long but this is due to the fact that the student had a range of relevant specific data that he could tap on to support claims made.

Is it really necessary to consider what countries 'should do'?

Further elaboration of point could be done briefly before presenting the examples.

A good development of the point can be found here when the student used the phrase 'what is made worse', because it shows the different levels and seriousness of the issue at hand.

Student has again very briefly highlighted what he thinks the government should do. This would be more ideal as part of the concluding thoughts and insights in the conclusion instead.

In conclusion, countries should encourage open trade with other countries today, as it brings about numerous benefits to people, companies and governments. However, the trade-offs of open trade being a multiplier of the problems of resources exploitation, the concentration of wealth and increasing income inequality, should not be neglected. Countries should regulate local companies, ensuring that they stay and provide jobs for the locals. Governments should also regulate the business practices and export of crucial resources and to advocate for business ethics and human rights, in an effort to reduce the severity of resource exploitation. If such measures were taken, countries should encourage open trade with other countries. Thus, I believe that countries should encourage open trade with other countries to a larger extent. GRADE: A (Low)	✓ Clear transitions and arguments stated to bring across the stand. ✓ Relevant insights.
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Learning Points:

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Relevant, wide-ranging and consistent illustration provided throughout the essay, demonstrating awareness of the issues raised in the question. Clear and relevant topic sentences provided at the start of each body paragraph.
- 

Transitions are being used at the start of the body paragraphs but these transitions were repetitive and 'boring'.

'There is no room for dreamers in today's world.' Comment.

STEP 1: Analyse the Question Requirements (QTK)

Q => Yes or No. Greater evaluation shown by arguing the extent of importance.

T => In a world today that focuses on practical results, dreamers may or may not have a place

K => Dreamers = individuals are typically assumed to thrive on ideals and unpractical beliefs, entertaining what others may consider to be lofty perceptions of what the world is or how it should be

No room = an absolute term with a context of a world that focuses on practical, tangible results, where dreamers have no place because of the assumption that they do not contribute in any tangible way to material progress

Today's world = Highly globalized, one that focuses on tangible results and outcomes (i.e. monetary), efficiency, etc.

STEP 2: Brainstorm for Relevant Content (5 brainstorming techniques)

PRESM/6 Players/IFCNG:

Social/Political/Moral/Psychological

- The world as it is is imperfect, and dreamers are important because they dream of a better world – socially and politically, this could mean the dream for greater political freedom and equality, the dream of emancipation from oppression and suffering. Dreamers could be those who dream to free others of their pain and suffering, and equally important are those who dream to be freed.
- Key examples of historical luminaries who 'dream' in the past and put their visions and beliefs into practice and benefit of mankind include Martin Luther King, Mahatma Gandhi, etc.
- In a globalised world that is increasingly mecurial, interwoven and less compartmentalised, dreamers are needed to feed the creative vibes in the realms of entertainment, entrepreneurship, etc. to constantly provide ideas that will push the development of these realms
- However, dreams without action, or delusional dreams, might not have a place in today's world. At the conceptual level, dreamers who dream of perfect freedom risk being overly-idealistic (e.g. the paradox of freedom – *'My freedom ends where your nose begins.'*)
- Dreamers who predominantly dream but not necessarily 'act' may arguably begin to have a greater place in terms of offering a psychological and spiritual perspective to counterbalance a world that is excessively preoccupied on tangible benefits and gratification, but neglects the more spiritual aspects of existence

STEP 3: Decide on Thesis

THESIS: In a rapidly modernising world rife with socio-political issues, we need dreamers more than ever before...

STEP 4: Organise Content

Qualified Thesis: Yes

<u>Intro + Thesis (GIST)</u> G: Donald Trump once said, "If you are going to be dreaming anyway, you might as well dream big." Indeed, the current President of the United States and real estate mogul was right, dreaming is a natural phenomenon, so why not make the most of it? I: As we sleep or simply gaze into space for a while, it is quite common for us to dream of say, a brighter future, or possibly, our definition of a utopia. For a young 5-year old, he or she might dream of a place of happiness and sunshine peppered with candy and toys, or for an aspiring politician, one might have dreams of a world of peace and prosperity. S: While anyone can dream, there are a certain group of dreamers who took these dreams one step further and applied them to reality. I believe it is precisely because of these people and their dreams, that society is where it is today. T: In a rapidly modernising world rife with socio-political issues, <u>we need dreamers more than ever before</u>, or more accurately, visionaries who can apply their dreams in reality to change and influence the world as we know it.	<u>Thesis</u> <i>* When a quote is given as a 'G', note that it should be contextually elaborated so as not to lay waste to it (quotations that are not contextually linked to the question are rarely helpful or value-adding). In this case, the writer has appended the quote with a rhetorical question to generate further interest and reflection that also helps to link to the argument proper.</i> <i>I: The writer has rather cleverly conjoined the literal interpretation of a dream (i.e. 'as we sleep') with the figurative one, which should be the conventional interpretation and focus of the essay's evaluation</i> <i>S: The 'sides' are put forth in a subtle fashion, via the inference that only dreamers who do not put their dreams into reality may arguably have no place in the world</i> <i>T: The stand does not directly answer the question, but could be inferred</i>
<u>Supporting BP1: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): The world is arguably a safer place now...Yet, it is precisely because of a special few visionaries who stood for equality and peace, dreaming of a world where everyone could co-exist in harmony, that we have seen this issue dwindle. L (concluding sentence): This is the need for dreamers in today's society.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is YES)</u> <i>*Note that the writer chose not to begin the first sentence of the BP1 and BP2 by addressing the question. However, this must be done with caution (refer to full essay on the following page) and if done effectively, adds creative and persuasive value to the writing</i>
<u>Supporting BP2: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): ...these dreamers may genuinely want to improve the lives of others, or purely for personal gain, it is undeniable that society does in benefit in some way or the other from the dreams of these people. L (concluding sentence, could also serve as the P): Thus, there is large room for similar dreamers in today's modernising world, and it is now easier for these dreamers to make their mark than ever before.	
<u>Supporting BP3: Reason for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): If we did not have dreamers in this world, people chock-full of imagination and creativity, the world would be a blander place. This is particularly so in the arts scene. L (concluding sentence): Thus, there is a need for dreamers in today's world, to keep the arts pulsing with life and excitement for the enjoyment of society.	
<u>Supporting BP4: Reason for No + Evidence + Brief Rebuttal + Restatement of Thesis</u> P (T.S.): However, there are those who believe that dreaming is a useless exploit. Even acting upon these dreams can result in failure, so why bother? In our hectic lives, one no longer has the time to simply sit down and let the mind wander, to dream of a better place. L (concluding sentence): Thus, they feel that dreaming gets nothing done and is a waste of time. P (brief rebuttal + thesis restatement): <u>That being said, it remains that</u> these dreams are what invigorate and drive change. Yes, simply dreaming may not accomplish much, but those who are able to act upon their dreams and create something better out of it have the potential to change the world today.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is NO and YES)</u>
<u>Conclusion: Considering these situations, I maintain largely No.</u> Ghanaian philosopher, Kwame Anthony Appiah, once asked what future generations would condemn us for. I believe it is forgoing the ability to dream in favour of realism [...] However, it is up to us to capitalise on our dreams and make the most out of them [...] The need for dreamers has never been more urgent [...] Should we lose our ability to dream and act upon them, to relegate them to the recesses of our minds and let them waste away, I believe the world would not only be progressing at a snail's pace, but would be colourless and even boring. Hence the room and requirement for dreamers in today's world.	<u>Reiterate Thesis</u> <i>* A relatively long conclusion, which could be in every way worth its length, if it is not just a mere restatement of points, but adds value by reiterating the key points with additional insight</i>

Ryan Leck 16A07 ‘There is no room for dreamers in today’s world.’ Comment. Donald Trump once said, “If you are going to be dreaming anyway, you might as well dream big.” Indeed, the current President of the United States and real estate mogul was right, dreaming is a natural phenomenon, so why not make the most of it? As we sleep or simply gaze into space for a while, it is quite common for us to dream of say, a brighter future, or possibly, our definition of a utopia. For a young 5-year old, he or she might dream of a place of happiness and sunshine peppered with candy and toys, or for an aspiring politician, one might have dreams of a world of peace and prosperity. While anyone can dream, there are a certain group of dreamers who took these dreams one step further and applied them to reality. I believe it is precisely because of these people and their dreams, that society is where it is today. In a rapidly modernising world rife with socio-political issues, we need dreamers more than ever before, or more accurately, visionaries who can apply their dreams in reality to change and influence the world as we know it. The world is arguably a safer place now, gone are certain social issues that were much more rampant in the era of say, the 19th and 20th centuries. Though, not completely. The issue of race and racism, while not as prevalent as before, still persists. Yet, it is precisely because of a special few visionaries who stood for equality and peace, dreaming of a world where everyone could co-exist in harmony, that we have seen this issue dwindle. People like Martin Luther King Jr. come to mind. He was able to change the lives of African-Americans everywhere in four words, “I have dream...”. In more modern times, however, we are yet pressed with other social issues, such as women’s rights. Hence the need for drivers of change towards this problem. Think Malala Yousafzai, who shot to the world stage at the tender age of 16, pressing for social changes, fighting for women of her country to be treated fairly. This drive was founded out of her dreams of a reality where women could go to school and be educated, where women could walk on the streets freely in Pakistan. It is people such as these who have taken their dreams of a bright future one level higher, going as far as to incite change for the better in our modern world. Who knows? Perhaps our generation will have a dreamer who later eliminates poverty, or finally establishes world peace? This is the need for dreamers in today’s society. Then, there are the dreamers who want to change the world in other ways. The brilliant inventors and scientists who want to boast their products to the world in the hope that it can change lives, or even to entertain and enjoy. They dream of marvellous and fantastical contraptions and ideas ahead of those in their generation. While some dreamers may simply strive purely for personal gain, it is undeniable that society does benefit in some way or the other from the dreams of these people. Visionaries such as Tesla founder Elon Musk push for the next step in science and technology, designing spaceships to send people to Mars, or electric-powered cars for a greener environment, all out of his vision and dream to make the world a better place. Similarly, it is because of these tech moguls such as Apple founder Steve Jobs that we are able to connect with the rest of society so efficiently and effectively nowadays, what with the revolution in mobile phones and the Internet. It was their dreams of an interconnected society that we have so benefited, albeit through their products. Thus, there is large room for similar dreamers in today’s modernising world, and it is now easier for these dreamers to make their mark than ever before. If we did not have dreamers in this world, people chock-full of imagination and creativity, the world would be a blander place. This is particularly so in the arts	Absolute ✓Relevant quote that is able to generate the interest of the reader effectively. The quote is also in line with the overall stand, thesis and tone of the essay. ✓A mature and insightful interpretation of ‘dreamers’. Student should present a balance of perspectives to address the assertion by the absolute trigger word ‘no’. Point should be clearly stated at the start of the BP before explanations. ✓Good range of examples provided that cuts across different generations. It was also good that the examples were concise and phrased in a way that was in line with how their dreams have made a difference in the world today. ✓Student considered a range of
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scene. George Lucas had dreams of a fantastical, epic space opera. That was why he put pen to paper, wrote and produced a series of films that would span decades, influencing millions around the world, titled “Star Wars”. In a similar vein, numerous artists and musicians apply their visions and dreams to their work, producing masterpieces for the pleasure of many of us. Rolling Stones guitarist Keith Richards quite literally dreamt the guitar riffs that would result in him writing the band’s chart-topping success “I Can’t Get No Satisfaction”. The imaginative side of the human mind is what drives the arts, an expression of one’s thoughts and visions put to media. Thus, without these dreamers, society today would be colourless place. With so much in the arts scene being based on dreams and imagination, it could be said that without these dreamers in today’s world, there would be no such thing as the arts. Thus, there is a need for dreamers in today’s world, to keep the arts pulsing with life and excitement for the enjoyment of society. However, there are those who believe that dreaming is a useless exploit. Even acting upon these dreams can result in failure, so why bother? In our hectic lives, one no longer has the time to simply sit down and let the mind wander, to dream of a better place. Instead, they believe that we should be focused on the task at hand, focused on what needs to be done. In this day and age, dreaming has become “goal setting”, where people are now concerned with hitting the next big number on an examination paper or investment return. Thus, they feel that dreaming gets nothing done and is a waste of time. That being said, it remains that these dreams are what invigorate and drive change. Yes, simply dreaming may not accomplish much, but those who are able to act upon their dreams and create something better out of it have the potential to change the world today. Ghanaian philosopher, Kwame Anthony Appiah, once asked what future generations would condemn us for. I believe it is forgoing the ability to dream in favour of realism. Dreams have the ability to incite radical change for the better. However, it is up to us to capitalise on our dreams and make the most out of them. Those who have done so have certainly shaped the world as we know it today. The need for dreamers has never been more urgent, and it has never been easier to make these dreams become a reality with our rapidly advancing world. Should we lose our ability to dream and act upon them, to relegate them to the recesses of our minds and let them waste away, I believe the world would not only be progressing at a snail’s pace, but would be colourless and even boring. Hence the room and requirement for dreamers in today’s world. GRADE: A (Low)	different areas where there is room for dreamers, continuing from world issues, to science and technology to the arts in this paragraph. ✓Apt illustration. Instead of simply stating ‘Star Wars’ and ‘Rolling Stones’, there was good use of apt vocabulary words to convey personal voice. ✓Clear transition to consider the other perspectives. More arguments for the other perspective should have been considered to lend greater depth and scope to the essay. When transiting back to the stand, there should be clearer links and engagement with the absolute word. ✓Relevant quote that helps to frame the overall thesis. It would have been better if the Donald Trump quote could be addressed in the conclusion too for greater thematic unity. ✓Relevant insights
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Learning Points:

-  Strong personal voice, use of appropriate vocabulary and rhetorical questions to drive the main message home for the readers. Examples are presented in a refreshing and concise manner with no unnecessary details.
-  Clearer transitions needed between paragraphs. Lack depth of evaluation and development of ideas when the other perspective is being considered. Hence, the links to the absolute word is not as clear.

In today's world, has ethics taken a backseat where food is concerned?

STEP 1: Analyse the Question Requirements (QTK)

Q => Yes or No. Greater evaluation shown by arguing the extent of importance.

T => The question of ethics in the area of food is often overlooked ironically as food is a basic need, but this question is increasingly important in today's world due to higher standards of living globally and greater literacy

K => ethics taken a backseat = 'to take a backseat' is a metaphor implying that ethics is not a priority, is secondary or even non-existent, and there are other aspects being prioritized (very often, economic and monetary in nature)

where food is concerned = the underlying assumption is that ethics could be a key concern in many areas of life but when it comes to food, people are willing to overlook ethical concerns in food in spite of it being a basic need (i.e. as long as it tastes good and does not cause illness, other concerns are secondary)

Today's world = highly globalized, with different kinds of food being able to be exported to various countries in a matter of days, and could be stored for longer periods due to more advanced technology

STEP 2: Brainstorm for Relevant Content (5 brainstorming techniques)

PRESM/6 Players/IFCNG:

Economic/Environmental/Ethical/Social

- A fast-moving world that focuses on utility and efficiency means that most people see food as a necessity that should be easily available; conversely, not many would, or believe that there is necessity to go to lengths to find out about how food is procured, as long as it is safe and tastes good. Such mentality supposedly closes the loop but covers the loopholes between the various tiers of food providers in the food chain and consumers, and there are bound to be lapses in ethical food production when economic concerns override them, e.g. in Taiwan, the use of recycled oil from drains to make traditional pastries, recent case of worms in canned sardines from China, etc.
- With humans as the locus of concern and the food industry being the source of multi-billion dollars of profits for firms across the world annually, there is an ongoing tendency to exploit resources in terms of plants and livestock, e.g. unethical housing and killing of livestock, unsafe practices of storing and processing food, etc.
- However, it is also true that scientists and producers are working together to produce food while conserving environmental resources through cutting-edge science, e.g. Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, using CRISPR gene editing technology to yield crops more consistently to feed the poor, while adhering to ethical standards in ensuring that there are no corresponding side effects
- Social activism and environmentalism have also pushed for greater awareness, as well as action to protect endangering species from being poached and consumed as food e.g. shark's fin, as well as more ethical and sustainable practices of obtaining food e.g. sustainable fishing in Taiwan
- Various government boards and authorities around the world recognise the importance of food safety and have stringent regulation and regular checks in place to ensure this e.g. Agri-Food and Veterinary Authority (AVA) of Singapore, Food and Drug Administration (FDA) in the U.S.

STEP 3: Decide on Thesis

THESIS: Hence, given how food corporations often chase profits when it comes to harvesting, producing or selling their food, there is a real possibility of them putting the ethics relating to the health of consumers at the backseat, making consumers worse off in terms of health.

STEP 4: Organise Content

Qualified Thesis: Yes

<u>Intro + Thesis (GIST)</u> G: Food is definitely something that mankind cannot afford to live without. I: Traditionally, we obtained food through hunting and farming, but in today's urbanised, technologically advanced world of ours, most of the food we eat or prepare is no longer truly our own. Rather, it is likely to originate from a farm or a manufacturing plant that we hardly consider. S: This brings about a serious concern: in the sphere of food manufacturing and consumption, has ethics been ignored completely? While there are efforts being made to combat such a trend... T: ...unfortunately the status quo of ethics taking a backseat in the context of food will likely to continue to hold for now.	<u>Thesis</u> G: <i>To achieve a direct impact, writer starts the introduction with a truism (i.e. a fact that is commonly and intuitively acknowledged)</i> I: <i>Without beating about the bush, the writer curtly but effectively weaves in the context of the essay that would be relevant to the argument</i> S/T: <i>With a relatively brief stroke, the author introduces the sides while agreeing that ethics is taking a backseat (*note that this is <u>not</u> an absolute statement) even when it is not completely ignored.</i>
<u>Supporting BP1: Reasons for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): In an era where most of the food that we consume or prepare is done "on our behalf" by corporation giants – be it Dole, Kraft or MacDonald's, there is a compelling case to make that these food companies will passively or even deliberately put health-related ethics in the backseat <u>in order to maximise profits on the food they harvest, process or sell.</u> L (concluding sentence): Hence, given how food corporations often chase profits when it comes to harvesting, producing or selling their food, there is a real possibility of them putting the ethics relating to the health of consumers at the backseat, making consumers worse off in terms of health.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is YES)</u>
<u>Supporting BP2: Reasons for Yes + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Furthermore, there have been concerns towards how we are mistreating the environment and animals when harvesting or producing food, ignoring environmental and animal ethics respectively for the sake of profits. L (concluding sentence): Henceforth, in today's world, our own lust for food, plus our ignorance, have led to environmental and animal ethics taking a backseat where food is concerned.	
<u>Supporting BP3: Reason for No + Evidence</u> P (T.S.): Nonetheless, the supposedly apocalyptic scenario of food lust trumping over even a single concern for ethics is akin to making mountains out of molehills. Activism and corporate social responsibility also do play an important role in preventing such a scenario from happening. L (concluding sentence): Therefore, by ensuring that the public does not entirely neglect the issue of ethics where food is concerned, activists play a role in ensuring that ethics need and should not be neglected by the food suppliers and producers, who will aim to deliver what consumers demand.	<u>Your Arguments</u> <u>(State when it is NO)</u> * Note that the organisation of the points of argument also conveys thoughtfulness and evaluation. The key thesis argument, which is also the most far-reaching, is placed first
<u>Conclusion: Considering these situations, I maintain Yes.</u> Yet, it must first be remembered that the embracement of corporate social responsibility (CSR) is rarely derived from altruistic aims. Rather, it is due to a need to appease the vocal minority of activists which can maximise profits among today's growing demographic of ethically-conscious consumers. <u>Furthermore, given how food is so fundamentally important to our survival, we are naturally inclined to remain apathetic to the way our food is harvested, produced and sold, as long as it remains good to eat, thus putting much of the work of activists and even CSR to waste. Henceforth, it is deeply regrettable that in today's world, collectively, we are still putting ethics behind our own concern for food.</u>	<u>Reiterate Thesis</u> * Reiterates the key overarching concern raised in the introduction, albeit in a different vein, to strongly argue for why and how ethics could still be, or easily be taking a backseat when it comes to food

In today's world, has ethics taken a backseat where food is concerned?

Food is definitely something that mankind cannot afford to live without. Traditionally, we obtained food through hunting and farming, but in today's urbanised, technologically advanced world of ours, most of the food we eat or prepare is no longer truly our own. Rather, it is likely to originate from a farm or a manufacturing plant that we hardly consider. This brings about a serious concern: in the sphere of food manufacturing and consumption, has ethics been ignored completely? While there are efforts being made to combat such a trend, unfortunately the status quo of ethics taking a backseat in the context of food will likely to continue to hold for now.

In an era where most of the food that we consume or prepare is done "on our behalf" by corporation giants – be it Dole, Kraft or MacDonald's, there is a compelling case to make that these food companies will passively or even deliberately put health-related ethics in the backseat in order to maximise profits on the food they harvest, process or sell. For instance, back in 2008, a Chinese infant milk corporation was caught red-handed for having dangerous levels of melamine in their milk powder, causing many parents the pain of seeing their infants fall ill to food poisoning. Similarly, there is still an ongoing controversy regarding how fast-food restaurants tend to mislead children (and their parents) into consuming too much fast food, leading to unprecedented levels of obesity. Using MacDonald's as a prime example, by advertising its kids' meals lovable mascots and bundling attractive toys with those meals, children often, no thanks to their parents – overconsume these unhealthy meals without realising the damaging impact it has on their own health. In fact, this debate has gone to such an extent that some American cities have gone all out to set calorie-based quotas when it comes to bundling toys with fast food meals to curb such information failure. Hence, given how food corporations often chase profits when it comes to harvesting, producing or selling their food, there is a real possibility of them putting the ethics relating to the health of consumers at the backseat, making consumers worse off in terms of health.

Furthermore, there have been concerns towards how we are mistreating the environment and animals when harvesting or producing food, ignoring environmental and animal ethics respectively for the sake of profits. For instance, palm oil – a common resource found in many food products we consume – is known to be harvested on land once covered by tropical forests, but cleared by "hack-and-slash" farmers to plant the financially lucrative cash crop that is oil palm to produce palm oil. This palm oil is then sold to food processing companies that potentially turn a blind eye to the environmental unsustainability of the process of deriving palm oil, thereby worsening the environmental problems of global warming and loss of ecological diversity. Similarly, in the meat industry, there have been ongoing concerns about how animals who are farmed for their meat are treated at the farms. An investigation in South Korean's dog farms, where dogs are reared for consumption, showed that many of these dogs were suffering from physical and psychological trauma, such as missing patches of body fur as a result of being enclosed in metal cages for most of their lives. While these environmental and animal concerns might not have such a direct impact on our lives, the degree to which we care about the violation of such ethics says a lot about our morality, sense of empathy and in the case of environment ethics, the ability to see the impact of our ignorance in the long run. These are all things our supposedly civilised society should embody. Henceforth, in today's world, our own lust for food, plus our ignorance,

Simple Polarity

Thesis lacks reason
Thesis = Stand + **Reason**

The advertising gimmick by Macdonald's appears to make a point that is different from the point argued by this BP. It would have been clearer if evidence of Macdonald's questionable food manufacturing processes was provided.

✓Examples and elaboration are effective in showing that the ethical issue persists in different food industries, and at each level of production and consumption.

have led to environmental and animal ethics taking a backseat where food is concerned. Nonetheless, the supposedly apocalyptic scenario of food lust trumping over even a single concern for ethics is akin to making mountains out of molehills. Activism and corporate social responsibility also do play an important role in preventing such a scenario from happening. Societal activism, whether it be from individual, non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and the like, constantly challenges and disrupts our common perception and passivity towards how we approach food, ensuring that ethics linking back to food harvesting and production or consumption remain in the public eye and accountable. For example, Animal Concerns Research & Education Society (ACRES) and World Wildlife Fund (WWF) are prominent examples of NGOs that organise public exhibitions and publish advertisement campaigns that urge consumers to be discerning in the purchase of common food products that contain palm oil, persuading them to use their dollar votes to encourage food producers to only source palm oil through more environmentally sustainable methods. Similarly, documentary maker, Morgan Spurnlock's critically acclaimed documentary – Super Size Me, generated much discussion on ethical issues relating to the promotion, manufacturing and consumption of fast food, and might have even been a key factor in MacDonald's decision to introduce 'healthier' options into their menus. Therefore, by ensuring that the public does not entirely neglect the issue of ethics where food is concerned, activists play a role in ensuring that ethics need and should not be neglected by the food suppliers and producers, who will aim to deliver what consumers demand. Yet, it must first be remembered that the embracement of corporate social responsibility (CSR) is rarely derived from altruistic aims. Rather, it is due to a need to appease the vocal minority of activists which can maximise profits among <u>today's growing demographic of ethically-conscious consumers</u>. Furthermore, given how food is so fundamentally important to our survival, we are naturally inclined to remain apathetic to the way our food is harvested, produced and sold, as long as it remains good to eat, thus putting much of the work of activists and even CSR to waste. Henceforth, it is deeply regrettable that in today's world, collectively, we are still putting ethics behind our own concern for food. Grade: A	✓ Balance is well-substantiated and qualified, and is consistent with the overarching thesis. ✓ Awareness of context of today's world ✓ Insightful and persuasive, showing depth of understanding of the issue.
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Learning Points:



Consistently relevant with effective use of examples. Overall, there is cohesion and cogency of arguments. 6-player framework effectively employed to bring scope to the essay. Good use of language and vocabulary.



Thesis should be clearly justified in the introduction paragraph. Example in BP1 could have been more clearly aligned to the point argued. With only 3 BPs provided, broader scope could have been achieved.

17S18 Vimal P

How effective are international efforts in solving environmental issues?

Glaciers are melting, sea levels are rising and the air and water are becoming filthier every day. While these are only some of the countless problems that our environment is facing, they have had and will still continue to have disastrous implications on the world and its people. One might often see posters showing stranded polar bears with a caption “Stop Global Warming, Do Your Part” or videos illustrating the terrible plight our oceans are facing due to pollution like oil spills. Although this may have a huge impact on the individual, one often believes that “there is so only so much I can do”. As such, many feel that collaboration is the key to tackling such problems. Countries across the globe can work together to solve environmental problems in a combined effort. However, this essay seeks to show that most international efforts are not very effective as they take too long to be ratified, tend to be unfocused and do not oblige countries to participate.

Firstly, international efforts to solve environmental issues are not effective when they require a long time before they can be carried out. International efforts are the collaboration among many countries across the globe. As such, the planning process of such large-scale collaborations can be extremely tedious and draining. In addition, proposals in “black and white” have to go through several rounds of vetting before they are approved. While this is necessary to ensure the international efforts are carried out smoothly, they often lose the battle with time, which is crucial as far as the environment is concerned. For instance, the Kyoto Protocol, an international agreement aimed at slowing down global warming through the reduction of greenhouse emissions, was made in 1997. It however only came into effect almost ten years later, as it took a very long time to be ratified. By then global carbon emissions had already skyrocketed by 40%, making future reductions questionable. As such, it is evident that international efforts to combat environmental issues are not always effective when they are unable to provide prompt solutions.

Moreover, international efforts tend to be fruitless when objectives are vaguely stipulated or unfocused. As international collaborations involve numerous countries, they often can have a scope that is too large or impractical. For example, in the recent Paris Climate Conference in France, participant countries pledged to limit the warming of the earth by a maximum of two degrees celsius in the next coming years. While this sounds like a solid plan, many countries were still at a fix as to how this can be achieved. Countries were also left unsure of the roles they have to play in the fight against the severe threat of global warming. This led to experts believing that the Paris Conference was a failure and that the target of two degrees is nearly impossible as there are no concrete plans made. Hence, it can be seen that international efforts may turn out pointless when there is no common understanding of the actions that have to be carried out by participants.

In addition, international efforts are not too useful in dealing with environmental problems, especially when countries are not obliged to participate. When efforts are merely on a voluntary basis, many countries might tend not to be involved, perhaps as they may be unwilling to provide resources. This often leads to the international effort being ineffective in its intended target, especially when major players refuse to participate. Addressing the issue of the Kyoto Protocol again, it was not legally binding which meant that countries that did not participate or failed to meet their targets were not penalised or punished. As such, it led to countries such as America (the second largest contributor of global carbon emissions) refusing to sign the treaty. America has since continued to release massive amounts of greenhouse gases from rapid industrialisation due to this. Therefore, when there is no authority

Simple Polarity

✓ Acknowledges the opposing argument; why international collaboration may seem the most effective.

✓ Well-qualified thesis

✓ Clear Point and Explanation

✓ Example supports the Point and Explanation fully

✓ Well-qualified link

✓ Clear Point and Explanation

✓ Good evaluative strategy used here; ideal vs. practical

✓ Well-qualified Point and Explanation

Another example would be good for variety of illustration.

Section C

Annabel Kuek 17A05

2018 J2 Common Test P2 (single-passage) Application Question:

The Economist looks at how internet retail has transformed and affected cities and the job market. To what extent do you agree with the opinions expressed in the passage? Support your answer with examples drawn from your experience and that of today's society. [10m]

EV = Evaluation

The Economist's view on the impact that e-commerce has on the country and job market remains **relevant and true** in my society.

The Economist stated that the impact e-commerce has on the job market is positive "but workers will need new skills as stores create more footfall." **This is a reliable statement** as with the benefits that e-commerce has brought about to the job market, it may be useless and even a disadvantage if workers fail to adapt to the changing landscape. This would lead to structural unemployment where the skills of workers do not match up to the skills required from the new jobs created by e-commerce. This may be detrimental to the economy. Hence this is why Singapore has introduced initiatives such as SkillsFuture that require the retraining of workers to ensure that they are better equipped with the necessary skills. This goes to show how e-commerce has transformed the job market so much that the traditional working skillsets are not sufficient in light of the great advancements brought about by e-commerce.

The Economist states that e-commerce has changed how "consumers spend their days." **This is a credible view** as with the increasing expansion of e-commerce, it has slowly infiltrated our daily lives, changing our lifestyles and spending habits. The convenience of e-commerce is such that there is no need to travel to a physical storefront but everything is available with the presence of any technological device. This would mean that it is much easier to access these stores and hence easier to get **sucked into the black hole of online shopping**. More and more people are found to be spending their time online shopping with 53% of mobile users spending their time online shopping, the PEW research centre found. In fact, it was found that online shopping remains top 5 on what Singaporeans indulge in on their mobile phones, as reported by The New Paper. **This may have even caused an addiction to online shopping as a result of e-commerce, leading to decreased productivity in people's lives. Where they could possibly be doing something more productive previously,** e-commerce has changed that by introducing the convenience of online shopping.

Furthermore, The Economist states that "debates over privacy will intensify" as a result of e-commerce. This **is a trustworthy view** as the drawbacks of e-commerce has resulted in the compromise of people's privacy and security. With the need to key in one's personal details ranging from one's address to their credit card details, **it is only inevitable** that uncertainty and doubts will arise as to where the information is being stored and what is being done with such information. In 2015, it was reported that as a result of the leakage of credit card details coupled with online scammers, e-commerce has resulted in an accumulative loss of \$3.8 million of their consumers. **This definitely raised alarm bells** and the question as to whether e-commerce is harmful or beneficial. More needs to be done to assure the people,

Extent of agreement should be indicated.

EV: Assess and develops on the impact of change if workers fail to stay relevant.

EG: Lacking details

EV: choice of words shows student's opinion of the change

EV: Explains impact + choice of words shows student's opinion towards the impact
EG: Specific examples provided
EV: Explains impact

EV: Explains nature of impact

EV: Explains impact
EG: Context of example unclear – local/global?

EV: Suggests resolution

besides just words of reassurance. Actions have to be carried out to avoid the harmful effects of e-commerce. <u>On the contrary</u>, The Economist states that e-commerce has led “to more products of better quality” and that it allows consumers to “spend far less time and effort.” <u>This an unreliable statement</u> as e-commerce <u>does not guarantee quality and may instead cost more time</u>. With e-commerce such as Redmart available in Singapore, as well as Zalora, consumers are now able to purchase their groceries and clothes online. However, <u>quality is hardly ensured. Unlike going to the physical store where consumers are able to physically inspect the product before purchasing, e-commerce does not allow that to happen.</u> Reviews and comments where the produce delivered were not fresh or that the clothing has holes or loose threads are a common occurrence, <u>dismissing the assumption of better quality goods.</u> Furthermore, <u>with an array of options available, consumers spend more time looking for what they want as they are spoilt for choice, dismissing the time-saving aspect of e-commerce.</u> Marks awarded: 9/10	EV: Explains why author's point may be inaccurate. EV: Comparison between traditional retail ad e-commerce EV
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Learning Points:



Consistent evaluation with relevant examples. Good use of language and vocabulary.



Opening line should have indicated extent of agreement, and could have been further developed by providing a reason for stand. Paragraph references and concluding paragraph are missing.

Nicole Yau Zhi Qi 17A06

2004 A-Level P2 (dual-passage) Application Question:

Victoria Sherborne argues strongly in favour of choice, whereas Tim Parks has grave reservations about the benefits it is supposed to bring.

Do you regard the increased degree of choice available to you and your generation as broadly beneficial or harmful? In your answer, develop some of the points made by the authors, and give your own views and some account of the experiences which have helped you to form them. [10m]

EV = Evaluation

I regard the increased degree of choice available to my generation as **broadly beneficial**.

In a seemingly competitive society like the one I live in today, I agree strongly with Sherborne when she states that choice allows us to enjoy the “pleasures of discrimination and assert our individuality”. As members of generation Z, we are clear of our likes and dislikes and would very much love to express ourselves. This expression could come in the form of fashion, music and even the art. Prom night usually means a lot to my generation as it marks the end of yet another educational milestone. It is then that we can choose to purchase a dazzling \$200 dress or tuxedo to doll up or a simple \$20 outfit to appear presentable. Some even go the extra mile to have their outfits tailor made so that no one would have the same outfit they do! There has also been an increase in content creators on YouTube who express themselves through the World Wide Web. This includes Tiffany Alvord, a self-taught singer, Night Owl Cinematics a local company which creates comedic content and even The Smart Local, another company start up to share more about Singapore to the world. The list of self-expressions available to my generation and me is endless and definitely builds confidence within us and is thus beneficial.

I, **on the other hand, strongly disagree** with Parks in his statement that we would be happier if we had decisions made for us. This is not apparent especially with my generation being such high achievers and perfectionists. Though it is true that not knowing the better things we could potentially be entitled to would lead to a more content life led, given our personalities, it is likely for us to fight for what we want rather than sit and whine at our plight. This in turn instils a strong fighting spirit in us. This also goes to show that we are not ranked top 3 for most resilient teens in the world for nothing. We are able to face setbacks and bounce back quickly. I would also like to counter the example on marriage. Instances of forced marriage be it in the developed or less developed countries have left some brides in pain, emotional, physical and psychological. This is often because they had no choice but to marry an older man to keep her family alive. If given a choice, these victims surely would not want to marry at such tender ages. Therefore, choices should not be made for us as we would turn out to be stronger individuals at the end of the day.

Both parties have differing views about distinction where Sherborne feels that distinction is beneficial while Parks views otherwise. With this debate at hand, **I would have to agree with both sides** and conclude that choice is only beneficial when given to the right person. With increasing guts of youth these days, what they may end up doing are crimes way beyond our imagination. At the tender age of 13, teens could turn to underage sex, smoking or even drugs. This is when they have

EV: Acknowledges SG Context

EV: Acknowledges perspective of Gen Z

EV

EG: Range of examples provided

EV: Assesses impact

EV: Acknowledges perspective of Gen Z

EV: Makes a comparison between impact of choice and destiny on Gen Z youth.

EG: More specific example needed

EV: Acknowledges perspective of victims

EV: Qualifies stand with an exception “only beneficial when given to the right person” + Acknowledges

tainted their ability to choose and have been put away in homes or correctional facilities to change their mind-sets. Similarly, there have also been instances of people volunteering to join the Singapore Armed Forces (SAF). This is an example of one choosing to have his or her life controlled by a higher up with the good intentions of helping with Singapore's security. Thus, this shows <u>that given a choice, impacts vary depending on how the person decides to use his right. It could be beneficial if used correctly and detrimental if used otherwise.</u> In conclusion, given the general nature of my generation, it is <u>more beneficial when</u> there is an increased degree of choice available. Taking into account that the right to choose is not misused and does not interfere with the law. Marks awarded: 9	perspective of Gen Z EV: Reiterates qualified stand
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Learning Points:



Consistent evaluation with relevant with examples. References both authors within a BP. Good use of language and vocabulary.



Opening line could have been further developed by providing a reason for stand. Paragraph references are missing. Examples could aim to achieve a broader scope or be more specific.